



TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 16

Date: Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: Utility Knife & Box Cutter Safety

OVERVIEW:

Utility knives cause more lacerations in the construction trades than almost any other single tool. They are used so frequently and so casually that operators stop thinking of them as dangerous. But a fresh utility blade is sharper than most surgical instruments, and a careless moment can result in a

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. The most important utility knife habit is retracting the blade immediately after every single cut — not after you are done with the task, not after you have made a few more cuts, but after every individual cut. A knife with an extended blade set down on a surface is a hazard to you and to every other person who reaches near that surface. Make retraction a reflex, not an afterthought.
2. Always cut away from your body. This means repositioning your body and the workpiece so that the knife travels away from your hands and torso on every stroke. If you are pulling the knife toward yourself, you are one slip away from a serious laceration. Reposition. Use a straightedge to guide straight cuts so you do not have to fight to keep the blade on line — fighting the blade is how
3. Replace dull blades frequently. A dull blade is more dangerous than a sharp one because it requires significantly more cutting pressure. That extra pressure means that when the blade does slip — and it will — it travels further and faster. Snap off dull blade segments using the blade cap — never with your fingers and never by bending the blade with the knife in your hand. Dispose of blade
4. Utility knives are cutting tools, not prying tools, not scrapers, and not paint can openers. Using them for tasks they are not designed for causes the blade to flex, snap, or bind in unexpected ways. Keep a dedicated pry bar, a scraper, and other appropriate tools on hand so you are not tempted to abuse the utility knife.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

- Q1: What is your current habit after you finish a utility knife cut? Are you retracting the blade every time?
Q2: Where do we dispose of used utility blades on this job site?

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- Retract the blade completely and immediately after each cut
- Cut away from your body and hands at all times without exception
- Snap off and dispose of dull blade segments properly using the cap
- Never use a utility knife to pry, scrape, or open paint cans
- Use a steel straightedge — not wood or plastic — for all guided cuts

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.



CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 16

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)	#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)
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